Liquid metal

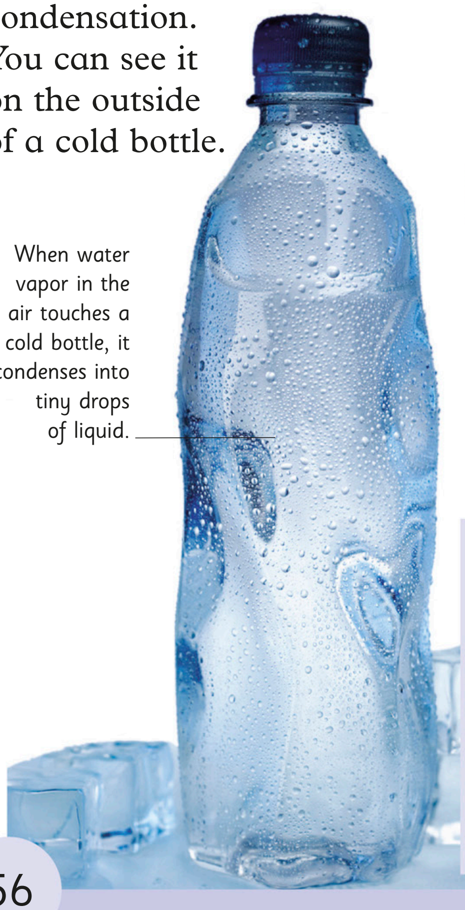
Many substances melt and boil at particular temperatures (its melting and boiling points). Most metals are solid at everyday temperatures because they have a high melting point. But mercury has such a low melting point that it is liquid even at room temperature.

Changing states

Many solids melt, to become liquids, when they become hot enough. When liquids get cold enough, they freeze and become solid. This is called changing states and it happens to all kinds of substances.

Condensation

As water vapor in the air is cooled, it changes into liquid water. This is called condensation. You can see it on the outside of a cold bottle.



When water vapor in the air touches a cold bottle, it condenses into tiny drops of liquid.

Changing states of water

Water exists as a solid, liquid, or gas. You can find all three forms of water in your home. They are ice, water, and water vapor.

Ice is solid water. It forms when liquid is cooled until it freezes. Each piece of ice has a definite shape.

When ice is warmed, it melts and becomes liquid and takes on the shape of the container holding it.

As water is heated, bubbles of water vapor (gas) form. They escape from the surface and condense to form a mist of liquid droplets called steam.

Rivers of iron

Iron must be heated in a furnace to make it melt. Molten iron is so hot it glows yellow. It is poured into a mold and left to harden to make solid iron objects.

Why does chocolate become soft and gooey in your mouth?